Perseverant Digital
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A FIELD GUIDE FROM PERSEVERANT DIGITAL · FOR LAW FIRMS

The Seminar Seat-to-Client Playbook

Plan an educational seminar or webinar that fills seats, gets registrants to actually show up, and turns the people in the room into booked consultations.

THE SHORT ANSWER · 60 WORDS

REVIEWED OCTOBER 15, 2026

Educational seminars and webinars still work when the decision is large and the buyer wants to learn before talking to anyone. Pick a topic phrased as the question your audience already has, promote two to three weeks out, send reminders by email and consented text, teach without pressure, and call every attendee within 72 hours to book the next conversation.

Is an event right for your business?

An event is worth the effort when the decision is large, the buyer wants to learn before talking to anyone, and you have someone who can teach in plain language. People are not only searching to find you; they are searching to understand you. A good event lets them do that in an hour.

- [ ] Buyers hesitate for weeks or months because the decision costs or matters a lot.
- [ ] You have a presenter who explains clearly and does not oversell.
- [ ] You can name one next step, such as a consultation, a home assessment or a tour.
- [ ] Someone can call every attendee within a day or two.

All four checked means an event is worth a trial. Otherwise, fix the gaps first.

What this looks like for law firms

Estate planning and family law seminars fit well. The questions are personal, and many people want to learn privately before they sit across a desk from a lawyer.

Research habits are shifting too. In a 2026 survey of 1,110 US adults by iLawyer Marketing, a legal marketing agency, the share using ChatGPT to research attorneys rose from 28.1% to 41.9% in a year. A summary can explain a trust. It cannot show how the lawyer who would handle the matter thinks. A seminar can.

The weak point is intake afterward. In a secret-shopper test of 500 firms in Clio's Legal Trends client intake guide (March 24, 2025), 48% could not be reached by phone. An attendee who calls the next morning and hits voicemail is a seat you paid for and lost.

What topic will actually fill seats?

Phrase the topic as the question your audience already asks, not as your service name. A title that names their worry fills seats. Rewrite these in the words your clients use on the phone.

Practice area	Topic phrased as the audience's question
Estate planning	What happens to your house if you die without a will?
Estate planning	Do you need a trust, or is a will enough?
Estate planning	Probate, explained: what your family will face and how long it can take
Family law	What to know before you file for divorce in this state
Family law	How custody decisions are made, and what parents can prepare

Question my clients ask most	Who asks it	Could I teach it in 45 minutes? (Y/N)

Should it be in person, a webinar or both?

Go in person when trust is the main barrier and the audience is local. Go webinar when the audience is spread out or busy. Choose hybrid only if you can staff two rooms at once.

Factor	In person	Webinar	Hybrid
Builds trust	Fastest	Moderate	Strong in the room only
Cost per attendee	Higher	Lower	Highest to run well
Biggest risk	Empty seats you paid for	Low live attendance	Neither audience gets full attention

Judge any format by cost per booked consultation, not cost per registration.

What does the 21-day timeline look like?

Promote two to three weeks out, as ON24, an enterprise webinar platform, advised on November 26, 2025. ON24 also advises reminders one week, one day and 15 minutes before; we add a confirmation and a morning-of message for local events.

Day	Task	Done
−28	Pick topic, date, venue or platform, and presenter	[ ]
−24	Build the registration page (checklist below) and confirmation email with a calendar link	[ ]
−21	Test reminders end to end; launch ads, email your list, send partners a blurb to forward	[ ]
−14	Second email; review cost per registration and cut what is not working	[ ]
−7	One-week reminder (email, text optional) with one thing they will learn	[ ]
−3	Rehearse; confirm room, tech and staff	[ ]
−1	One-day reminder (email and text) with time, place or link, parking or tech note	[ ]
0	Morning-of and 15-minute texts with the address or link; run the event	[ ]
+1 to +3	72-hour follow-up (below)	[ ]

Registration page checklist:

- [ ] Headline that repeats the topic question, with date, time and place above the form
- [ ] Three bullets on what attendees will learn, and a short factual presenter bio
- [ ] Form: name, email, phone, and an unchecked text-consent box that says they can reply STOP
- [ ] A plain line that the event is educational and nobody will be pressured

Do not ask about the person's legal matter on the form. That belongs in a confidential consultation.

How many registrations do you actually need?

Work backward from the seats you want filled.

Seats wanted ÷ show rate = registrations needed Registrations needed ÷ page conversion rate = clicks needed Clicks needed × cost per click = estimated ad budget

Example numbers, not benchmarks. For 30 people in the room at a 50% show rate, you need 60 registrations. At 15% page conversion, that is 400 clicks. At $2.50 per click, about $1,000 in ads.

For context, ON24 reported a 60% average registrant-to-attendee rate in its 2025 data (June 19, 2026). That is a vendor figure drawn mostly from B2B enterprise webinars, not a target.

Line	Your number
Seats wanted	
Expected show rate	
Registrations needed	
Page conversion rate	
Clicks needed	
Cost per click	
Estimated ad budget	
Consultations booked	
Ad budget ÷ consultations booked	

Run the last line after every event. It tells you whether to keep going.

What should happen during and after the event?

Teach first and name one next step. Answer the title question in the first ten minutes, leave 15 minutes for questions, and explain exactly what happens in the consultation, assessment or tour. End with a feedback card or poll: “Would you like someone to call you?” yes or no.

Then move fast. In Harvard Business Review research on online leads (March 2011), firms that contacted leads within an hour were nearly seven times as likely to qualify them as firms that waited longer. Attendees are warmer than web leads, but the clock still applies.

When	Attendees	Registered no-shows
Same day	Thank-you email with a summary and booking link	Replay or next date
Day 1	Call everyone who said yes on the card	Text (with consent) offering the replay
Day 2	Call remaining attendees once	Second email with one key point
Day 3	Email anyone not reached with a booking link	Invite to the next event

For law firms, skip the Day 2 calls: phone only attendees who asked for follow-up, and send everyone else the summary.

Track each attendee in one list: attended, wants a call, called, booked, became a client.

What compliance items apply?

Check these before launch. This is general information, not legal advice.

- **Filing ads.** Florida requires most ads filed at least 20 days before first use (websites exempt), which is tight inside a 21-day window. Texas requires filing within 10 days of first use.
- **No implied results.** ABA Model Rule 7.1 bars misleading communications. No “specialist” or “expert” claims without recognized certification.
- **Solicitation.** Rule 7.3 limits live person-to-person solicitation, so call only attendees who asked. Texas HB 2733 (effective September 1, 2025) extends barratry law to social media and electronic messages.
- **Texting.** The TCPA still requires prior express written consent for autodialed marketing texts. Since April 11, 2025, people can revoke by any reasonable means, such as replying STOP, and opt-outs must be honored within 10 business days (Kelley Drye; Burr & Forman).
- **Email.** CAN-SPAM covers B2B email too: accurate headers, a postal address and opt-outs honored within 10 business days (FTC). Bulk Gmail senders also need SPF, DKIM and DMARC (Google, February 1, 2024).

Where do most owners get stuck?

> **Filling seats at a sane cost.** The first event shows your real cost per registration. Lowering it takes testing topics, audiences and creative across several events before the money runs out.

> **Reminder automation across email and text.** A sequence that pulls from your form, respects text consent, honors STOP and stops for cancellations takes systems work most teams do not have time for.

> **Intake that keeps up with the event.** One evening can produce a dozen consultation requests. Answering every call, running conflict checks and booking within a day takes an intake process few firms have tested under that load.

If any of these sound familiar, a 25-minute exploration call can help you sort out the next step. Use the short form at the end of this guide.

Sources

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- Texas Legislature, “HB 2733,” effective September 1, 2025. link

Want a second set of eyes on what you found?

Book a free 25-minute exploration call. We will look at your answers with you, name the first fixes in order, and tell you honestly if we are not the right fit.

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